THE UNDERESTIMATE CLUB

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This document is the single source of truth for the TUC student-facing dashboard. It covers product vision, design system, every screen and its states, all user flows, copy guidelines, tech stack, edge cases, and what not to build at launch. Build exactly what is described here.

Authors: TUC Founding Team. Questions before implementation begins must be directed to the founding team.

1. PRODUCT VISION

The Underestimate Club is India's first private ecosystem built exclusively for underestimated elite talent — students and alumni from Tier 1 institutions who are sharp, driven, and chronically overlooked by mass-market hiring platforms.

TUC is not a job board. It is not a portal. It is a curated, trust-based network where every student is verified, every founder is real, and every match is intentional. The student dashboard is the student's private command centre inside this network.

On LinkedIn, Internshala, and Unstop — every student looks identical. A CGPA. A list of clubs. An internship at some company. Founders waste hours reading resumes trying to figure out who can actually think.

TUC solves this with three things: institutional verification so only Tier 1 talent gets in, the Hustle Score so founders get one signal they can trust, and a curated bounty feed so students stop spray-and-praying.

IITs (all campuses), NITs (all campuses), IIITs (all campuses), IIMs (all campuses), BITS Pilani, SRCC, LSR, St. Stephens, Ashoka, Flame, Plaksha, Shiv Nadar, Krea, and equivalent top institutions. Total whitelist: 149+ institutions. Domain verification is the gate. Alumni who have lost institutional email access use LinkedIn + degree certificate verification.

Students	Currently enrolled at a whitelisted institution. Seeking internships, full-time roles, co-founders, or cohort learning.
Alumni	Graduated from a whitelisted institution. Seeking full-time, fractional, advisory, or founding team roles. Different filters and onboarding flow.
Founders	Posting bounties. Reviewing student profiles. Accepting or rejecting intros. Separate dashboard — NOT covered in this document.

2. DESIGN SYSTEM

COLOUR TOKENS	
Page background	#0A0A0A — full page. Never pure black.
Card / Panel	#111111 — all cards, sidebar, drawers.
Elevated card	#1A1A1A — hover state, secondary cards.
Border	#2A2A2A — all borders and dividers.
Primary green	#00FF85 — CTAs, active states, scores, badges, score numbers.
Muted green	#00CC6A — hover state of primary CTAs.
White text	#FFFFFF — headings and primary labels only.
Body text	#CCCCCC — paragraphs, descriptions, card content.
Muted text	#888888 — meta info, timestamps, secondary labels.
Amber	#FFAA00 — pending states, warnings, inactivity alerts.
Error red	#FF4444 — rejected states, errors, destructive actions.
Platinum gold	#C9B037 — Platinum badge only. Nowhere else.
Section header	#0D0D0D — table headers, section background blocks.

TYPE SPECIFICATIONS	
Primary font	Space Mono — ALL text across the entire dashboard. No exceptions.
Fallback	monospace — system fallback only if Space Mono fails to load.
Import	Google Fonts: fonts.google.com/specimen/Space+Mono — load weights 400 and 700 only.
Display	48px / 700 — page-level greetings only. e.g. Namaste, Aryaman.
H1	36px / 700 — section headers within a page.

H2	28px / 700 — card titles and major subsections.
H3	22px / 700 — subsection labels, field labels.
Body	16px / 400 — all descriptive copy.
Meta	13px / 400 — timestamps, tags, secondary labels.
Button text	14px / 700 — all button labels. All caps.
Badge text	12px / 700 — all badge and pill labels.

NOTE: *Space Mono is monospaced. Line lengths will feel shorter than proportional fonts. Adjust container widths accordingly. Test every copy block with the longest expected string — especially names like Harshavardhan Venkataraman and institution names like Visvesvaraya National Institute of Technology.*

UI COMPONENT SPECIFICATIONS	
Cards	border-radius 12px. border 1px solid #2A2A2A. background #111111. padding 24px.
Card hover	border-color transitions to #00FF85 at 40% opacity. transition 150ms ease.
Primary button	background #00FF85. text #000000 bold 14px caps. border-radius 8px. padding 12px 24px. hover background #00CC6A.
Ghost button	background transparent. border 1px solid #00FF85. text #00FF85. Same sizing as primary.
Disabled button	background #2A2A2A. text #555555. cursor not-allowed. No hover effect.
Input fields	background #1A1A1A. border 1px solid #2A2A2A. focus border #00FF85. text #FFFFFF. border-radius 8px. padding 12px 16px.
Sidebar	width 240px fixed. background #111111. border-right 1px solid #2A2A2A.
Sidebar active	background #1A1A1A. left-border 3px solid #00FF85.
Badge / Pill	border-radius 999px. padding 2px 10px. font-size 12px bold.
Tooltip	background #1A1A1A. border 1px solid #2A2A2A. border-radius 8px. padding 12px. max-width 260px. z-index 999.

Side drawer	width 480px. slides in from right. background #111111. border-left 1px solid #2A2A2A. page behind dims to 40% opacity.
Page padding	32px all sides on desktop. 16px on mobile.
Card row gap	16px between cards in a horizontal row.
Section gap	48px between major page sections.

Desktop	1280px and above. Full sidebar visible. Two-panel layouts active.
Tablet	768px to 1279px. Sidebar collapses to icon-only (56px wide). Single column cards.
Mobile	Below 768px. Sidebar becomes bottom tab bar with 5 icons: Dashboard, Bounties, Messages, Profile, More. All cards full width. No horizontal scrolling.

CRITICAL: *The sidebar on mobile is a known UX failure pattern. Do not show the sidebar on screens below 768px. The bottom tab bar is non-negotiable.*

3. ONBOARDING AND LOGIN FLOW

Single screen. No multi-step wizard. Fields: Full name, Institutional email, Password, User type (Student or Alumni dropdown), Year of study (if Student: 1st to Final Year; if Alumni: hide this field).

On submit: validate email domain against the 149+ institution whitelist. Send OTP to email. OTP valid for 10 minutes. Resend available after 60 seconds.

Domain Whitelist Edge Cases

- Some IITs use department-specific subdomains like cse.iitb.ac.in alongside iitb.ac.in. Whitelist must handle both root domain and all subdomains of whitelisted institutions.
- Alumni often lose institutional email access 6 to 12 months post-graduation. Alumni verification path: LinkedIn URL showing institution + degree certificate upload (PDF or JPG, max 5MB). Both required together. Manual review within 48 hours by TUC team.
- Student cannot find their institutional email. Show a help text: Your institutional email usually ends in .ac.in. Check your college website or student portal. Do not let them proceed with a personal Gmail.
- Student uses a whitelisted domain email that actually belongs to a different institution (e.g. a college with a similar domain). Flag for manual review if the name and institution declared don't match the domain.

Autosave During Onboarding

Autosave all onboarding answers every 30 seconds to localStorage as a draft. If the session times out or the browser closes, restore the draft on next login with a banner: We saved your progress. Continue where you left off.

NOTE: *Never use the word Test or Exam anywhere in onboarding. Call this section Your TUC Profile Questions.*

QUESTION 1 — SAME FOR EVERY STUDENT

Screen label: Before we match you, tell us how you think.

Question: Describe a problem you noticed around you recently and how you would solve it.

Input: Free text area. Word limit: 150 words. Live word counter visible. No formatting options. Autosave every 30 seconds.

QUESTION 2 — PERSONALISED TO RESUME AND SKILLS

This question is auto-generated from the skills the student lists during signup or from the resume they upload. Examples:

- SQL listed: Walk us through a data problem you have actually solved. What was the input, what did you do, what was the result.
- Figma or design listed: Take us through how you approach a design brief from scratch. What is your first step.
- No specific skills yet: Tell us about a time you built or shipped something, however small. What was it and what did you learn.

Input: Free text area. Word limit: 100 words.

Answer Quality Edge Cases

- Student submits blank or gibberish answer (spaces to hit word count): detect minimum sentence count (at least 3 complete sentences). If not met, show: This answer seems incomplete. Please elaborate.
- Answer submitted in Hindi, Tamil, or another Indian language: show a note Please answer in English so our team can evaluate fairly. Do not silently score a non-English answer.
- Answer appears AI-generated (unusually formal, perfect structure, no personal anecdote): flag for manual review. Do not auto-reject. Store a flag in the database: ai_suspect = true. TUC team reviews within 48 hours.
- Two students submit near-identical answers (WhatsApp group sharing a good answer): run a cosine similarity check against all previous submissions. If similarity exceeds 85%, flag both accounts for manual review. Do not auto-reject.

QUESTION 1 — PERSONALISED TO RESUME

Same logic as Student Question 2. Auto-generated from their uploaded resume or declared work history.

QUESTION 2 — ROLE PREFERENCE (DROPDOWNS)

What kind of roles are you exploring? Options: Tech (TPM, Engineering, Cybersecurity, Data), Non-Tech (Consulting, Product, Founder's Office, Strategy, Marketing), Both.

Second dropdown appears immediately: What level are you targeting? Options: Individual Contributor, Manager or Lead, Founding Team or 0 to 1 roles, Open to anything.

QUESTION 3 — CURRENT STATUS (HANDLE WITH CARE)

Screen note above the question in muted text: This is private. Founders never see this. We use it only to prioritise your matches.

Question: Are you currently between roles?

Options: Yes, I was recently laid off (a text field appears: Company name and approximate timeline), No, I am actively employed, I am exploring passively.

This question is optional. Show: Answering this helps us match you 40% faster. Do not force it.

4. SIDEBAR NAVIGATION

Fixed left sidebar. Width 240px. Background #111111. Border-right 1px solid #2A2A2A. Always visible on desktop. Collapses to icon-only on tablet. Replaced by bottom tab bar on mobile.

SIDEBAR ITEMS — TOP TO BOTTOM	
Logo area	UNDERCLUB wordmark in #00FF85. Small. 14px. Not a large logo. Positioned top-left with 20px padding.
User card	Avatar circle (initials-based if no photo). Name in white 14px bold. Institution + Year in muted 12px. Hustle Score badge e.g. 84/100 in green 12px.
Dashboard	Home icon. Default page after login. No badge.
Profile	Person icon. No badge.
Bounties	Diamond icon. Green badge pill showing unread matched roles count e.g. 12.
Cohorts	Grid icon. Badge only if a new cohort track opens.
Find Co-founder	Heart icon. No badge by default.
Messages	Chat bubble icon. Green badge showing total unread count across ALL thread types.
War Room	Shield icon. Shows locked state until profile is complete. Unlocks on completion.
Thin divider	1px line in #2A2A2A before Logout.
Logout	Bottom of sidebar. Muted text. No icon. Clicking shows confirmation popup.

Trigger: click Logout. Show a small centred modal.

Copy: Leaving already? Your matches will miss you. (Not really. But come back soon.)

Two buttons: Yes, log me out (ghost button) and Actually, stay (primary green button). Default focus on Actually, stay.

5. DASHBOARD — HOME SCREEN

The first screen after login. Minimal. No clutter. Maximum 3 sections visible without scrolling. One primary green CTA on the whole screen. This is the cockpit, not a feed.

Left aligned. No card wrapper. Direct text on page background.

- Line 1: Namaste, [First Name]. — Display size, bold, white.
- Line 2: [Institution] · [Dept] · [Year] — Body size, muted.
- Line 3: Hustle Score: [XX]/100 | Top [X]% of TUC — Score number in green, rest in muted.

Copy variant A (3 or more profile views today): [N] founders checked you out today. No pressure though.

Copy variant B (no views today): The grind continues. Your profile is looking sharper than [X]% of TUC.

Copy variant C (brand new user, score not yet calculated): Welcome. Your score is being calculated. Come back in a few minutes.

NOTE: *If the student's first name is non-Indian (Alex, Kevin, Sarah), skip the Namaste and use: Good to see you, [First Name]. Do not force cultural references on names that don't fit.*

Three equal-width tiles in a horizontal row. Background #111111. No individual borders needed. Gap 16px between tiles.

Tile 1	Large number (36px green bold): Roles matched. Label below in muted 13px: Roles matched
Tile 2	Large number: Intros sent. Label: Intros sent
Tile 3	Large number in amber if > 0, else green: Pending replies. Label: Pending reply

NOTE: *No charts. No graphs. No progress rings. Numbers only. If any stat is 0, show 0 in muted colour, not green.*

One card. The highest match percentage role from the student's matched bounties. Full section label: YOUR BEST MATCH TODAY in 12px muted caps.

- Role title: [Role] — [Company] in 22px bold white
- Meta: [Stage] · [Mode] · [Compensation] in 14px muted

- Match badge: [XX]% match in green pill, top right of card
- Two buttons: REQUEST INTRO (primary) and See all [N] roles (ghost)

After clicking REQUEST INTRO: button becomes INTRO SENT, grey, disabled. A line appears below: We will nudge them so you do not have to.

Edge case: if the student has no matched roles yet (empty profile), show: Complete your profile to unlock your matches. With a CTA: Finish my profile. (4 minutes.)

Section label: WHAT'S BEEN HAPPENING — 12px muted caps. Subtitle in brackets: (while you were probably in class)

Show maximum 4 lines. Text only. Activity description left, timestamp right in muted. Below the 4 lines: See all activity — small muted link, right aligned.

ACTIVITY TYPES AND COPY	
profile_view	[Company] HR viewed your profile
intro_pending	Your intro to [Company] is still pending (founders are busy humans too)
new_match	[N] new roles landed that match you
score_update	Your Hustle Score updated to [XX]
badge_earned	You earned the Platinum badge
intro_accepted	[Company] accepted your intro. Check Messages.
intro_rejected	[Company] passed this time. [N] other roles are waiting.
message_received	New message from [Name] at [Company].

NOTE: *Activity feed fetches on page load. No real-time at launch. Implement real-time WebSocket updates in Version 2.*

6. PROFILE TAB

Profile tab contains ONLY personal information and resume. No bounties, no cohorts, no co-founder content inside this tab.

Shown at the top of Profile if completion is below 100%.

Copy: Your profile is [XX]% done. The last [YY]% is where the good matches hide. CTA button: Finish it. Takes 4 minutes.

COMPLETION WEIGHTS	
Full name	10%
Skills (min 3 tags)	20%
Bio	10%
Resume uploaded	30%
LinkedIn URL	15%
Gauntlet complete	15%

FIELDS AND RULES	
Full name	Text input. Editable. Max 60 chars. Test with Harshavardhan Venkataraman.
Email	Read only. Verified badge next to it. Not editable after signup.
Institution	Read only. Set during signup. Show verified tick icon.
Department	Text input. Editable. e.g. Computer Science, Mechanical Engineering.
Year of study	Dropdown. Editable. Options: 1st Year to Final Year. Alumni see Graduated [YYYY].
LinkedIn URL	Text input. Required for alumni. Optional for students. Validate URL format.
Skills	Tag input. Type and press Enter to add. Max 15 tags. Min 1 character per tag.
Bio	Text area. 200 char max. Optional. Label: One line about what you build or care about.

Profile photo	Optional. Circle crop. Accepts JPG or PNG. Max 2MB. Auto-resize on upload. If not uploaded: initials avatar.
Preferred name	Optional. Short name for greetings. If filled, greeting uses this instead of full first name.

Section header: Your Resumes. Below all profile fields. Students and alumni can upload up to 3 resumes. Each resume has a label they set so they know which to pick during an intro request.

- Upload zone: drag and drop or click. Accepts PDF only. Max 5MB per file. Max 3 files total.
- Each uploaded resume shows: custom label (editable), filename, upload date, View button and Delete button.
- If student uploads DOCX: show error — Your resume must be a PDF. Open your Word doc, go to File then Save As then PDF.
- Label input appears immediately after upload: Give this resume a name — text input max 30 chars. Required before saving. Placeholder: e.g. Product Resume, General CV, Tech Resume.
- If 3 resumes already uploaded: hide upload zone. Show — You have 3 resumes saved. Delete one to upload a new version.
- Edge case: student uploads Aadhaar card or random document. Basic check: PDF must contain extractable text and be at least 1 page. If image-only scan with no text: This does not look like a resume. Please upload a text-based PDF.
- Completion weight: 30% credit given as soon as 1 resume is uploaded. Uploading 2 or 3 does not add additional completion %.

When a student or alumni clicks REQUEST INTRO on any role, a popup appears before the intro is sent asking which resume to attach. The intro is not sent until they confirm.

Popup title: Which resume should we send?

Shows all uploaded resumes as selectable radio cards. Each card shows the custom label and upload date. Pre-selected: most recently uploaded resume.

- If only 1 resume uploaded: popup still appears with one option and a note — You can upload more resumes in Profile to tailor each application.

- If no resume uploaded: popup shows a block — You have not uploaded a resume yet. Founders expect one. CTA: Go to Profile. REQUEST INTRO is blocked until at least one resume exists.
- After selecting: student clicks Confirm and Send Intro. Popup closes. Button state changes to INTRO SENT.
- The selected resume ID is stored against that intro record in the database. Founder always receives exactly the resume the student chose.

After onboarding questions are completed and scored, show a small badge at the top-right of the Profile page. Label: Gauntlet Complete. Background #00FF85. Text black. Not a full section, just a badge. This is the only reference to the Gauntlet after onboarding.

When a student enters their final year, show a banner on Profile: You are entering your final year. Update your status to unlock alumni-specific features. CTA: I have graduated. Clicking this transitions their account to Alumni type, updates filter defaults on Bounties, and sends a verification reminder if their institutional email is expiring.

7. BOUNTIES TAB

Where students browse and apply to roles. Every role is posted by a verified founder or HR. This is TUC's core product feature and the biggest differentiator vs Internshala and LinkedIn.

Section label: ROLES MATCHED TO YOU — 12px muted caps. Page title: Bounties. Subtitle: Every role here is posted by a verified founder. Your resume attaches automatically when you request an intro.

Full width. Placeholder: Search roles, companies, skills... Searches simultaneously across role title, company name, skill tags, and role type. Live filtering as user types with 300ms debounce. No separate search button needed.

Three tabs: Recommended, All roles, Saved. Active tab has 2px green underline. Recommended is the default tab for both students and alumni but behaves differently for each.

Recommended Tab — Students

Students see a Recommended tab showing their top matched roles sorted by match %. No AI-generated explanation. No Why you are a great fit section. Just the standard role cards ranked by relevance to their profile. Clean and fast.

Recommended Tab — Alumni

Alumni see a Recommended tab showing a curated list of maximum 10 to 12 roles. Each role card includes an AI-generated Why you are a great fit section with 3 specific bullet points. This is alumni-exclusive.

How it works: backend runs match algorithm to find top 10 to 12 roles for that alumni. Then fires a single batched API call to Claude to generate the Why you are a great fit content for all matched roles simultaneously. Results cached per alumni per day. Cache invalidated when alumni updates their profile or any matched role changes.

Why You Are a Great Fit — Alumni Card Structure

Each recommended role card for alumni expands inline (not a drawer) to show the 3 AI-generated bullets below the standard card content.

- Example bullet 1: Your 3 years of product experience at a Series B company directly matches what they are building at this stage.
- Example bullet 2: Your B2B SaaS background aligns with their Fintech focus. You have done this before.
- Example bullet 3: Your Hustle Score of 84 is above their stated minimum of 75. You clear the bar.

NOTE: *The Why you are a great fit section never appears for students on any tab or in any drawer. Students see match % only.*

Horizontal scrollable row. Always visible. Active chips show filled with X to remove. Clear all link appears when any filter is active.

- Role Type: Internship / Full-time / Contract
- Track: Product / Tech / Strategy / Marketing / Founder's Office
- Mode: Remote / Hybrid / In-office
- Stipend: Rs. 10k+ / Rs. 20k+ / Rs. 30k+
- Stage: Seed / Series A / Series B / Series D+
- Duration: 1 month / 2 months / 3 months / 6 months
- Platinum roles: Toggle on/off

More filters link expands Stage, Duration, and Platinum toggle for users who need them.

NOTE: *Default filter state on page load: pre-select Role Type and Track based on what the student specified in onboarding. Students can always clear and browse everything.*

- Role Type: Full-time / Fractional / Advisory
- Track: Tech / Non-Tech / Both
- Mode: Remote / Hybrid / In-office
- CTC: Rs. 12 LPA+ / Rs. 20 LPA+ / Rs. 30 LPA+ / Rs. 50 LPA+
- Seniority: Individual Contributor / Manager or Lead / Founding Team
- Stage: Any / Early / Growth / Late
- Actively hiring: Toggle — urgent roles only

CRITICAL: *Never mix compensation formats. Students see monthly stipend. Alumni see annual CTC in LPA. Same card component, different data format per user type.*

Full width horizontal card. Background #111111. Border #2A2A2A. Hover: border #00FF85 at 40% opacity. The card itself is not clickable. Actions happen through explicit buttons only.

CARD LAYOUT — ALL ELEMENTS	
Top left	Company name (bold white) + Funding stage pill (e.g. Series D) + Platinum eligible badge if applicable
Verified line	Posted by Verified Founder — small muted text with green checkmark icon. Below company name.
Alumni signal	If a TUC alumnus works at this company: 1 TUC alumnus here — muted green text.
Role title	Largest text on card. 20px bold white. e.g. Product Intern — Growth and Retention
One-liner	12-word max role description written by the founder. e.g. Own the full growth funnel for a D2C brand.
Skill tags	Grey pill chips: Product, Growth, SQL, Remote etc. Max 5 visible, rest truncated with +N more.
Top right	Compensation. Monthly for internships (Rs. XX,XXX/mo). LPA for full-time (Rs. XX LPA). Equity-only: Equity (details in JD)
Below comp	Role type + duration. e.g. Internship · 3 months
Match badge	[XX]% match — green pill. Info icon next to it for tooltip.
Deadline	X days left or Closes when filled in amber if under 5 days remaining.
Read full JD	Small ghost text link below the one-liner: Read full job description. Clicking opens a popup modal with the complete JD. Not a side drawer.
REQUEST INTRO	Primary green button. Bottom right of card. Clicking opens the resume selection popup.
Bookmark	Outline bookmark icon top right corner. Toggles filled on click. Saves to Saved tab. Inline microinteraction, no popup.

NOTE: *Filled roles do not appear in the Bounties tab at all — for any tab (Recommended, All roles, or Saved). When a founder marks a role as filled, it is immediately removed from all student and alumni views. If a student had saved the role, it disappears from their Saved tab too. No ROLE FILLED state shown in Bounties. Filled roles simply vanish.*

Opens when student clicks Read full job description on a card. Centred modal overlay. Background #111111. Max width 640px. Scrollable if content is long. Closes on X or clicking outside.

- Modal header: Role title + Company name
- Section: About the role — full job description
- Section: What they are looking for — skills, mindset, experience requirements
- Section: About the company — stage, team size, one-liner
- For alumni only: Section: Why you are a great fit — 3 AI bullets (only on Recommended tab roles)
- Footer: REQUEST INTRO full width primary button + Bookmark ghost button side by side

This popup replaces the side drawer entirely. Simpler, faster, works better on mobile.

Default	REQUEST INTRO — green background, black bold text
Clicked	Triggers resume selection popup — button unchanged until popup confirmed
After confirm	INTRO SENT — grey background, disabled, no hover
Pending	INTRO PENDING — amber background, disabled
Accepted	INTRO ACCEPTED — green check icon, disabled
Rejected	REAPPLY IN X DAYS — red background, countdown visible

The match score is computed server-side per student-bounty pair using a weighted formula:

Skills overlap	35% — exact and semantic match between student skills and role requirements
Role type preference	20% — matches student's declared preference from onboarding
Availability match	15% — duration and start date alignment
Hustle Score threshold	15% — founder may set a minimum score; distance from that threshold
Location/mode match	10% — remote preference alignment

Year of study	5% — founder may specify year preference

Match % tooltip (on hover of info icon): Based on your skills, year, track preference, and Hustle Score. This updates as you improve your profile.

Edge case: if student profile is empty, show Complete your profile to see your match score instead of 0%. Never show 0% match — it makes the platform look broken.

Edge case: founder uses an unusual skill tag the system has never seen (e.g. competitive chess). System must compute a partial match from other factors and not throw an error.

There is no hard cap on intro requests. Students can apply to as many roles as they want. However, when a student sends more than 5 intros in a single session, show a one-time popup. This is not a block. It is a nudge.

Popup copy: Quality over quantity. Founders spend real time reviewing every intro. The students who get hired send fewer, sharper applications. You can keep going — just make sure each one counts.

Two buttons: Got it, keep going (primary green) and Let me review my intros (ghost). The popup appears once per session only. Do not show it again after the student dismisses it.

No roles match filters: Nothing here right now. Not because you are not good enough. Founders post in waves. Check back tomorrow. Meanwhile your profile could use one more project. Just saying. CTA: Update my profile.

Saved tab with deleted or filled role: role disappears from Saved tab automatically when founder marks it filled or deletes it. No stale filled role cards shown anywhere.

8. HUSTLE SCORE — THE CORE DIFFERENTIATOR

The Hustle Score is not a feature. It is the product. It is what makes TUC different from every hiring platform in India. On every other platform, a student from IIT and a student from a tier-3 college look structurally similar on a resume. The Hustle Score cuts through that and gives founders one trusted signal.

CGPA	Measures memory. Hustle Score measures execution thinking.
College brand	IIT tag is table stakes on TUC. Score is the differentiator within the network.
Club positions	Anyone can be a secretary. Score tests actual problem-solving ability.
Internship count	Quantity is easy to game. Score reflects quality of articulation and output.
Resume keywords	Keywords are gamed instantly. Score is generated from actual written responses, not claimed skills.

SCORE FORMULA	
Onboarding Q1 answer	30% — evaluated on clarity of problem identification and execution thinking.
Onboarding Q2 answer	25% — evaluated on evidence and specificity, not claims.
Profile completeness	15% — based on weighted field completion. Resume upload alone is 10% of this.
Skills relevance	15% — how well listed skills match active bounties. Updated weekly.
Response rate	10% — speed and consistency of reply to accepted intros. Ghosting founders drops score.
Activity signals	5% — meaningful actions only: profile edits, intro requests, cohort participation. Raw logins do NOT count.

CRITICAL: *Do not count raw daily logins in the activity signal. A student refreshing the app to game the score must not be rewarded. Only meaningful actions count.*

VERDICT COPY	
90 to 100	EXCEPTIONAL — Honestly? We are a little impressed.
75 to 89	STRONG — Top tier and you know it.
60 to 74	SOLID — A few tweaks and you break into the top tier.
45 to 59	GROWING — Room to grow. The good news: so did every 84 scorer.
Below 45	STARTING OUT — That is fine. Everyone was here once.
Not yet	CALCULATING — Your score is being computed. Check back in a few minutes. Show this for new users, never 0/100.

Top 5%	Show percentile in #C9B037 (gold). Rare signal.
Top 12%	Show in primary green #00FF85.
Top 25%	Show in standard green.
Top 50%	Show in muted green.
Below 50%	Do not show percentile at all. Just show the raw score.

Percentile label copy: Top [X]% of TUC members. Update percentile monthly, not in real-time. Add a note: Percentile updates monthly, so a student whose score stays the same but whose rank shifts doesn't feel punished.

- Dashboard home: large number, verdict, percentile
- Sidebar user card: small badge e.g. 84/100
- Profile page: full breakdown with improvement notes

- Bounties: each role shows minimum score required if founder set one
- Co-founder cards: score visible on every co-founder profile
- Founder view (separate product): first thing founders see on a student
- Match algorithm: one of 6 inputs to the match % calculation

Show exactly 3 improvement notes below the score card on both Dashboard and Profile. Must be specific to the individual. Never generic. Generated from actual gaps in their answers and profile.

BAD — generic	Be more specific about execution steps.
GOOD — specific	Your response on scaling missed one concrete metric. Add a number next time.
BAD — generic	Quantify your decisions with timeframes.
GOOD — specific	You listed SQL but gave no example of a result. Add one project outcome.
BAD — generic	Address stakeholder communication earlier.
GOOD — specific	Your bio is empty. One line about what you build goes further than you think.

NOTE: *If the backend cannot generate a specific improvement note, skip that slot entirely. Never fill with a placeholder. Two specific notes are better than three generic ones.*

The Hustle Score is not static. It decays with inactivity to keep the platform engaged and ensure scores reflect current, not historical, energy.

- No activity for 14 days: score drops by 2 points. Send email: Your Hustle Score dipped to [XX]. Log in to recover it.
- No activity for 30 days: score drops by 5 points. Send email with stronger copy.
- Score cannot drop below the baseline earned from onboarding answers. The Q1 and Q2 scores are permanent.
- Grace period: if the student has never had a decay event before, first inactivity window is a warning email only, no score drop. This protects students during exam season (April, November in India).

NOTE: *Decay runs as a nightly cron job. Simple database query. Not a complex calculation.*

A student may create two accounts with different emails to retake the onboarding questions for a better score. Detection methods:

- Same LinkedIn URL on two profiles: flag immediately
- Same resume document (compare file hash on upload): flag immediately
- Same phone number if collected: flag immediately
- Near-identical onboarding answers across two accounts: flag via similarity check

Flagged accounts go to the admin queue. TUC team reviews within 48 hours. Do not auto-delete.

9. COHORTS TAB

Students browse and enroll in cohort programs. Five tracks. Paid via Razorpay.

COHORT TRACKS AND PRICING	
Product	Rs. 5,499
Founder's Office	Rs. 5,499
Strategy	Rs. 5,499
Marketing	Rs. 5,999
Tech (Engineering)	Rs. 6,999

- Track name, icon, duration (e.g. 6 weeks), format (Live sessions + async projects)
- Outcome: Platinum badge on completion + capstone project on profile
- Pricing with bracket copy: Rs. 5,499 (Costs less than one bad bootcamp.)
- CTA: Enroll Now — triggers Razorpay checkout

CRITICAL: *Implement idempotency keys on every Razorpay transaction. A student must never be charged without being enrolled, and must never be enrolled without being charged.*

- Payment success but enrollment fails: webhook must retry enrollment. Send confirmation email only after database confirms enrollment, not just after payment gateway returns success.
- Double charge: use Razorpay's order ID as idempotency key. Never create two orders for the same student + cohort combination.
- Payment page timeout: student is on Razorpay checkout and closes tab. Order remains pending. On next visit to Cohorts, check for a pending order and resume the checkout rather than creating a new order.
- Refund request: define refund policy clearly on the enrollment page before payment. Suggested: 100% refund within 24 hours of enrollment, 50% within 7 days, no refund after 7 days.

Earned by: completing cohort program AND submitting capstone project AND receiving manual approval by TUC team. All three required.

Badge colour: #C9B037. Label: Platinum. Appears on student Profile, on their Bounties card when founders view them, and on their co-founder profile card.

Earned screen copy: You earned it. Platinum. Not everyone gets here. Seriously. Only 14% of TUC members do.

10. FIND CO-FOUNDER TAB

If student has not activated Builder Mode, show a gate screen. Copy: Looking for your person. The one who does what you do not. Builder Mode is Rs. 100 per month. (That is 2 cutting chais at any Bengaluru cafe.)

CTA: Activate Builder Mode. Triggers Razorpay. After payment confirmation: tab unlocks immediately.

NOTE: *Do not charge for Builder Mode until you have at least 50 active co-founder profiles on the platform. If active profiles are below 50, make it free or show a waitlist. Charging students for a feature with no other users on the other side destroys trust instantly.*

RULES	
Price	Rs. 100 per month
Request cap	30 connection requests per week. Not per month.
Cap reset	Resets every Monday at midnight IST regardless of when they subscribed.
Response window	4 days. If no response, request expires automatically. Both parties are notified.
Chat access	Unlocks in Messages tab after mutual acceptance. No external contact info shared before mutual acceptance.
Profile shown	Name, institution, skills, builder bio (max 2 lines), Platinum badge if earned. Hustle Score is NOT shown on co-founder profiles.

- Name + institution + year
- Skills tags (max 5 visible)
- Builder bio: max 2 lines
- Platinum badge if earned
- Hustle Score is NOT shown on co-founder cards. Co-founder matching is about complementary skills and vision, not score ranking.
- CTA: Send Request — deducts 1 from weekly cap

- Cap counter: 24 of 30 requests remaining this week — visible below filters. Resets Monday midnight IST.

Every chat thread in Messages has a Report this conversation option and a Block this user option. This is non-negotiable. Without these two controls, a bad actor can harass someone with zero recourse. Report goes to TUC admin queue. Block immediately hides the user from the blocked student's view across the entire platform.

11. MESSAGES TAB

One unified inbox for all conversation types. Students never need to go to different tabs to find their chats. Entry to a chat is contextual (from Bounties, Co-founder tab, or directly from Messages), but the conversation always lives here.

Use Stream Chat SDK. Free up to 100 MAU. Integration time 5 to 7 days. Do not build from scratch.

CRITICAL: *Monitor MAU weekly. Upgrade to Stream paid plan before hitting the 100 MAU ceiling, not after. At the ceiling, chat breaks for new users. This is a trust-destroying moment if it happens during a launch spike.*

Two-panel layout on desktop: left panel is thread list (320px), right panel is active conversation. On mobile: full screen thread list, tap to open conversation, back button to return.

Filter bar at top: All | Bounties | Co-founder | TUC. Default: All.

THREAD TYPES AND RULES	
Bounty thread	Opens after founder or HR accepts intro. Student cannot initiate. Founder sends the first message. If founder accepts but never messages within 48 hours, TUC sends them an automated nudge email. Student sees: Waiting for [Company] to start the conversation. We have nudged them.
Co-founder thread	Opens after mutual acceptance of connection request. Either party can message first.
TUC system	One-way messages from TUC team. Badge updates, approvals, announcements. No reply option shown.

- Sender messages: right side, #00FF85 background, black text
- Receiver messages: left side, #1A1A1A background, white text

- Timestamps: below each message cluster in muted 12px
- Read receipts: single tick sent, double tick delivered, green double tick read
- File sharing: resume PDF via paperclip icon. File shown as preview card in chat. Max 5MB. If file exceeds limit: This file is too large. Maximum size is 5MB. Compress your PDF and try again. Never silently fail a file upload.
- Character limit: 1000 characters per message
- No voice messages at launch
- No last seen real-time indicator. Do not create pressure on either side to respond immediately.

If a message contains a phone number pattern or email address, show a non-blocking warning below the message: For your security, we recommend keeping conversations within TUC. Do not block the message at launch. Just flag it.

12. WAR ROOM TAB

War Room contains exactly one thing: a one-time Discord community invite link. Nothing else. No tracking tables, no application history, no analytics. Just the link to the inner circle.

A single screen with the TUC Discord invite.

- Headline: You are in. Welcome to the War Room.
- Subline: This is where the real network lives. One link. One community. Do not share it.
- Large CTA button: Join the TUC Discord — opens Discord invite in new tab
- Below button in muted text: This is a one-time link. Screenshot it if you need it later.
- Small note at bottom: This is a private server. Membership is verified. Stay sharp.

War Room unlocks immediately after the student completes their profile (all required fields + Gauntlet complete). They do not need to send an intro first.

Locked state copy: Almost there. Complete your profile to unlock the War Room. Progress bar showing % complete.

CRITICAL: *Do NOT generate Discord invite links in advance during onboarding. Generate them on-demand when the student first opens the War Room tab. Discord server configuration changes (Community Mode, 2FA, verification level) can silently invalidate pre-generated links.*

- Use Discord API to create invite: POST /channels/{channel.id}/invites
- Set max_uses to 2, not 1. Reason: student may click and close the tab before actually joining. max_uses = 1 leaves them with no way back in.
- Set max_age to 2592000 (30 days). After 30 days, generate a fresh link on next War Room visit.
- Track actual Discord server membership via Discord API GET /guilds/{guild.id}/members — do not assume the student joined just because they clicked the link.

- Show You are now in the Discord only after server membership is confirmed via the API, not just after link click.
- If student is already in 100 Discord servers (Discord hard limit), the invite will fail. The student may see a confusing Discord error. Add a confirmation prompt after they click: Did you successfully join the TUC Discord? Yes / No. If No: show support contact.
- If student shares the link with a friend who is not a TUC member: the extra use_count is available (max_uses = 2) but their Discord join will be detected as a non-TUC-registered user. A Discord bot should assign a verification role only to members whose Discord ID is linked to a TUC account. Unverified joiners should be placed in a holding channel and rejected within 24 hours.

If a TUC admin bans a member from the Discord server for misconduct, a manual flag must be added to their TUC account in the admin dashboard. One person on the founding team owns Discord moderation. SLA: ban reviews within 24 hours of report.

Add a note on the War Room screen: This is a community with standards. Misconduct results in permanent removal from TUC and the Discord server.

Add a note below the Join button: Best experienced on the Discord app. With direct links to App Store and Google Play Store. Discord web on mobile is limited and the join flow can fail or confuse first-time users.

13. NOTIFICATIONS

Notification bell in top-right of header. Badge count = total unread across all types. Clicking opens a dropdown panel showing the 10 most recent notifications.

NOTIFICATION TRIGGERS AND COPY	
Intro accepted	Push + in-app: [Company] accepted your intro. Head to Messages.
Intro rejected	In-app only: [Company] passed this time. [N] other roles are waiting.
Profile viewed	In-app: [Company] HR checked your profile today.
New role match	In-app: [N] new roles just matched your profile. Check Bounties.
Message received	Push + in-app: New message from [Name] at [Company].
Co-founder request	In-app: [Name] from [Institution] wants to connect.
Score update	In-app: Your Hustle Score moved to [XX]. Here is why.
Badge earned	Push + in-app: Platinum unlocked. You are in the top 14%.
Score decay warning	Email only: Your Hustle Score dipped to [XX]. Log in to recover it.
Intro nudge popup	In-app popup after 5th intro in a session: Quality over quantity. Make each one count. One-time per session only.
Builder cap low	In-app: You have 5 co-founder requests left this month.

If a founder accepted a student intro but has not logged into TUC for 10 days, trigger an automated email to the founder: You have a student waiting to hear from you. [Student name] from [Institution] sent you an intro [X] days ago.

On the student's side: show a status on that intro in their activity: Founder response delayed. We are following up on your behalf.

14. ACTIVITY LOG — DATABASE SCHEMA

ACTIVITY_LOG TABLE	
user_id	Foreign key to users table. Indexed.
activity_type	Enum: profile_view, intro_sent, intro_accepted, intro_rejected, new_match, score_update, badge_earned, message_received, co_founder_request, system
message	Human readable string. e.g. Boldfit HR viewed your profile.
metadata	JSON. Stores company_id, role_id, match_count, score_value etc. for dynamic message generation.
actor_id	Who triggered the event. e.g. founder user_id for a profile view. Null for system events.
created_at	Timestamp. Indexed for fetch performance.
is_read	Boolean. False by default. Mark true when user sees it.

Fetch the 4 most recent rows for the dashboard feed. Fetch all rows with pagination (20 per page) for the full activity page accessible via See all activity.

Profile view tracking: when a founder opens a student profile, INSERT a profile_view row for that student. This is how students see who viewed them.

15. COPY AND TONE GUIDELINES

Every string of text in the student dashboard must follow these rules. This is not optional. The copy is part of the product.

Warm but not sycophantic. Smart but not corporate. Honest. Feels like a sharp friend built this, not a VC-backed startup trying to sound premium. Indian cultural references where they fit naturally. Never forced.

The bracket rule: use a bracket aside — (like this) — as the whisper layer. The human moment. The thing the corporate version would never say. Use it maximum once per screen. If it appears everywhere, it loses all charm.

- No em dashes anywhere. Use a comma or a full stop instead.
- No exclamation marks in UI copy. Let the message do the work.
- No AI-sounding phrases: game-changing, cutting-edge, world-class, seamlessly, robust, leverage (as a verb), synergy.
- Write in second person: You, Your. Not the student or users.
- Internal platform mechanics are never revealed in public-facing copy.
- Namaste greeting: only use for Indian first names. Fallback: Good to see you, [Name].
- Tone for alumni: same voice, slightly more grounded. Alumni are 24 to 27 years old professionals. The chai joke lands differently for them.

SCREEN COPY REFERENCE	
Dashboard greeting A	Namaste, [Name]. [N] founders checked you out today. No pressure though.
Dashboard greeting B	Namaste, [Name]. The grind continues. Your profile is looking sharper than [X]% of TUC.
Score — Exceptional	84/100. Exceptional. Honestly? We are a little impressed.
Score — Growing	61/100. Room to grow. The good news: so did every 84 scorer.

Intro sent	Intro sent to Zepto. Now the hardest part: waiting. We will nudge them so you do not have to.
Profile incomplete	Your profile is 84% done. The last 16% is where the good matches hide. Finish it. Takes 4 minutes.
Builder Mode gate	Looking for your person. The one who does what you do not. Builder Mode is Rs. 100 per month. (That is 2 cutting chais at any Bengaluru cafe.)
Cohort price bracket	Rs. 5,499 (Costs less than one bad bootcamp.)
Platinum earned	You earned it. Platinum. Not everyone gets here. Seriously. Only 14% of TUC members do.
Chat empty state	No messages yet. Worst case they do not reply. Best case your next chapter begins here.
War Room headline	You are in. Welcome to the War Room.
Logout confirm	Leaving already? Your matches will miss you. (Not really. But come back soon.)
Bounties empty	Nothing here right now. Not because you are not good enough. Founders post in waves. Check back tomorrow.
Gauntlet pre-screen	One shot. No retakes. Not to stress you out. Just to keep the quality of TUC members at a level that actually means something. You have got this. Probably.

16. FULL EDGE CASE REGISTRY

Every known edge case for the student dashboard. Each must be handled before launch. Marked with priority: P0 = must fix before launch, P1 = fix in first two weeks post-launch, P2 = fix in first month.

P0 — Department subdomain emails	cse.iitb.ac.in must pass whitelist same as iitb.ac.in. Whitelist all subdomains of all 149 institutions, not just root domains.
P0 — Alumni email expiry	Alumni cannot use expired institutional email. Verification path: LinkedIn URL + degree certificate upload. Manual review within 48 hours.
P0 — Blank or gibberish answer	Detect minimum 3 complete sentences. If not met, prompt: This answer seems incomplete. Please elaborate.
P0 — AI-generated answer	Flag for manual review. Store ai_suspect = true. Do not auto-reject. Review within 48 hours.
P0 — Near-identical answers	Run cosine similarity against all submissions. Above 85% similarity: flag both accounts.
P0 — Session timeout during onboarding	Autosave to localStorage every 30 seconds. Restore draft on next login with a banner.
P1 — Non-English answer submitted	Prompt: Please answer in English so our team can evaluate fairly.
P1 — Student cannot find institutional email	Show help text. Do not hard-block. Give a support contact.
P2 — Lateral transfer student	Student changes institution mid-degree. Email domain may change. Allow re-verification with new institutional email.

P0 — Brand new user score	Never show 0/100. Show CALCULATING state until score is ready.
P0 — Login gaming	Raw logins do not count toward activity signal. Only meaningful actions count.
P0 — Fake skills on profile	Validate skills against Q2 answer. If they list SQL but answer never references data, flag for review.
P0 — Duplicate accounts for gaming	Detect via same LinkedIn URL, same resume hash, same phone, near-identical answers. Flag for manual review.

P1 — Percentile shift without score change	Student stays at 72 but percentile drops from 25% to 31%. Show rolling 30-day percentile. Add note: Percentile updates monthly.
P1 — Exam season decay	First inactivity event = warning email only, no score drop. Protects students in April and November.
P2 — Score improvement notes fail to generate	Skip that slot. Show 2 specific notes rather than 3 generic ones.

P0 — Empty profile match score	Never show 0% match. Show: Complete your profile to see your match score.
P0 — Filled role visibility	Filled roles vanish immediately from all tabs — Recommended, All roles, Saved. No ROLE FILLED badge shown. Clean removal with no delay.
P0 — No resume on REQUEST INTRO	Block intro. Show popup: You have not uploaded a resume yet. CTA: Go to Profile. Cannot send intro without at least one resume.
P0 — Multiple resume upload limit	Max 3 resumes. If 3 exist: hide upload zone. Show: Delete one to upload a new version. Label required before saving any resume.
P0 — Intro nudge popup	After 5th intro in a session, show a one-time popup. Not a block. Student can continue. Shows once per session only.
P1 — Why you are a fit — alumni only	Students see Recommended tab with match % sorted cards only. Alumni see Recommended tab with AI bullets. Cap alumni at 10 to 12 roles. Cache per day. Invalidate on profile update or role change.
P1 — AI generation cost control	Batch all 10 to 12 Why you are a great fit calls in one API request. Cache per alumni per day. Never call on every page load.
P1 — Resume label missing	Label required before resume is saved. Do not allow unlabelled resumes in the system.
P1 — Resume selection popup edge cases	If 1 resume: popup shows one option with nudge to upload more. If 0 resumes: popup blocks and sends to Profile. Selected resume ID stored against intro record.
P1 — Hustle Score on co-founder cards	Hustle Score must NOT appear on co-founder profiles or cards anywhere. Remove entirely from that context.
P1 — Co-founder weekly cap reset	Cap of 30 resets Monday midnight IST every week. Not monthly. Not billing anniversary. Document clearly in the UI counter.

P1 — Unusual founder skill tag	Unknown skill tag must not break match algorithm. Compute partial match from other factors.
P1 — Equity-only role compensation	Show: Equity (details in JD) — never show a blank compensation field.
P1 — Saved role gets deleted by founder	Show: This role is no longer available. With a link to similar active roles.
P1 — Compensation format consistency	Students see monthly. Alumni see LPA. Never mix on the same page.
P2 — Founder posts duplicate roles	Detect duplicate role titles from the same founder posted within 24 hours. Prompt: Is this a duplicate?

P0 — Link clicked but not joined	Use max_uses = 2. Verify actual Discord membership via API. Show confirmation prompt.
P0 — 100 Discord server limit	Student at Discord's server limit. Their join fails. Show confirmation prompt: Did you join successfully? If No: show support contact.
P0 — Pre-generated links invalidated	Generate invite on-demand when student opens War Room. Never pre-generate.
P0 — Link shared by student	Discord bot assigns verification role only to TUC-registered members. Non-TUC joiners go to holding channel and are removed within 24 hours.
P1 — Discord server settings change	Document this as a known risk. Any change to verification level or 2FA on the server invalidates existing invite links.
P1 — Mobile browser join failure	Show note: Best on the Discord app. Include App Store and Play Store links.
P1 — Banned Discord member	Manual flag on TUC account. Admin SLA 24 hours. TUC and Discord ban together.

P0 — File upload fails silently	Never silently fail. Show error with file size, format, and instructions to compress.
P0 — Stream Chat MAU ceiling	Monitor weekly. Upgrade before hitting 100 MAU ceiling, not after.
P0 — No block or report option	Every thread must have Report and Block. Non-negotiable.

P1 — Founder accepts intro but never messages	48-hour automated nudge email to founder. Student sees: Waiting for [Company]. We have nudged them.
P1 — Off-platform contact shared	Detect phone and email patterns. Show non-blocking warning. Do not block the message.
P2 — Last seen pressure	Do not show real-time last seen. Removes anxiety from both sides.

P0 — Razorpay payment success but enrollment fails	Idempotency keys on every transaction. Webhook retry on enrollment failure. Email only after DB confirms enrollment.
P0 — Platform down during peak placement season	October to November and February to March are peak windows in India. Uptime SLA must be designed around these months.
P1 — Student graduates mid-session	Show year-transition banner in final year. CTA: I have graduated. Transitions account to Alumni type.
P1 — Long name display overflow	Test with Harshavardhan Venkataraman everywhere: sidebar, greeting, cards, notifications.
P1 — Profile photo with wrong aspect	Auto-resize and circle crop. Define max resolution: 2048px. Max file size: 2MB.
P1 — Founder goes dark after accepting	10-day inactivity trigger: automated nudge email to founder. Status update to student.
P2 — Builder Mode with no co-founder profiles	Do not charge for Builder Mode until 50 active co-founder profiles exist on platform.
P2 — Builder Mode cap reset date	Resets on billing anniversary, not calendar month. Document this clearly in billing UI.
P2 — Admin flag queue SLA	All flagged accounts reviewed within 48 hours. One founding team member owns this queue.

17. TECH STACK

FRONTEND	
Framework	React.js with Next.js for server-side rendering
Styling	Tailwind CSS with custom dark theme config
Font	Space Mono from Google Fonts. Weights 400 and 700.
State	Zustand or Redux Toolkit
Animations	Framer Motion — subtle only. Not overdone.
Icons	Lucide React
Charts	Recharts — lightweight, sufficient for any stats needed

BACKEND	
Runtime	Node.js with Express or NestJS
Database	PostgreSQL (primary) + Redis (sessions and cache)
Auth	JWT + refresh tokens. Email OTP for signup verification.
File storage	AWS S3 or Cloudflare R2 for resumes and uploads
Real-time	Socket.io for notifications. Stream Chat SDK for all messaging.
Email	Resend or SendGrid for transactional emails
Payments	Razorpay with idempotency keys on all transactions
Cron jobs	Node-cron or a managed scheduler for score decay, nudge emails, cap resets
Discord	Discord REST API for invite generation and member verification

MATCH ALGORITHM	
V1 — Launch	Weighted formula: skills overlap 35%, role type 20%, availability 15%, Hustle Score 15%, location 10%, year 5%. Simple. Fast. Explainable.
V2 — Growth	Layer semantic embeddings using OpenAI text-embedding-3-small or HuggingFace sentence-transformers. Catches non-exact skill overlaps.

V3 — Scale	Collaborative filtering. Use placement data to improve recommendations over time.
Storage	Store score breakdown per student-bounty pair. Needed for match % explanation tooltip. Cache Why you are a great fit results per alumni per day.

18. WHAT NOT TO BUILD AT LAUNCH

Scope discipline is as important as the build itself. These are explicitly out of scope for Version 1.

Real-time activity feed	Fetch on page load is sufficient. WebSocket updates in V2.
AI suggestions inside chat	Plain chat is fine. AI suggestions add complexity and cost with no V1 user need.
Voice or video calls	Text chat only at launch.
Public profiles	No student profile is visible outside TUC. Private network only.
Mobile app (iOS or Android)	Web responsive first. App after product-market fit.
Social feed or posts	TUC is not a social network. No feed.
Referral system	Build after you have users worth referring to.
Group cohort chat rooms	Discord handles community. TUC Messages is 1-to-1 only.
Builder Mode at zero profiles	Do not launch Builder Mode as paid until 50+ co-founder profiles are active.
Semantic match algorithm	Weighted formula is sufficient for V1. Embeddings in V2.

The Underestimate Club — Student Dashboard PRD v1.0 — March 2026 — Confidential

All questions about this document must be directed to the TUC founding team before any implementation begins. Do not assume. Ask.